

UNSHACKLED TRUTH MEDIA

A FREE REFLECTION

The Cracks Don't Define You

*Three honest reflections for anyone who
is starting to believe they are too far gone.*



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FROM CHRIS

Start here

At sixteen I was sentenced to life in prison. For twenty-three years I believed the sentence was the truest thing about me. I was wrong.

I grew up in the wreckage of addiction, abuse, and broken promises. I learned early to hide the broken little boy behind an image, and I ran from the pain with anything that would numb it. The running led me somewhere I could never take back, and a cell I thought I would die in.

But even in the darkest cells, God was there. His grace broke through the cracks in my rebellion and rewrote a story I thought was finished. I am home now. I am free in every way that matters, and I was free in Christ before the gate ever opened.

These three short reflections are the same questions that started my healing. They will not fix everything in three pages. They are a beginning, and beginnings are holy. Grab a pen, find ten quiet minutes, and be more honest than you have ever let yourself be.

“If you have ever felt forgotten, unworthy, or trapped in cycles you can't escape, my story is living proof: grace still breaks chains.”

THE CRACKS BENEATH THE SURFACE

No one is too far gone. Not even you. - Chris

The Crack

Everyone has a crack, the place where the damage started long before anyone else could see it. Mine started in a childhood I misread, with feelings I never learned to name and wounds I decided were my fault.

A crack is not proof that you are broken beyond repair. It is the place where the pressure finally showed. And here is the part that took me decades to see: the crack is also where the light gets in. God does not wait for you to be sealed up and presentable. He meets you at the exact point of the break.

“The LORD is nigh unto them that are of a broken heart; and saveth such as be of a contrite spirit.”

PSALM 34:18

REFLECTION ONE · YOUR TURN

Where did my crack start? Write about the earliest wound you can remember.

What did I decide about myself because of it? Say it plainly.

ONE MOVE TODAY

Tell one safe person, or tell God out loud, one true sentence about where your damage started. Just one sentence. Out loud.

The Mask

I spent years protecting the broken little boy with an image: tough, in control, needing nobody. The mask kept people out, but it kept the pain in. You cannot heal a wound you refuse to admit is there.

Taking the mask off does not happen all at once. It happens one honest moment at a time, with God first, because He already sees behind it and loves you anyway. You have nothing to protect in front of Him.

“But the LORD said unto Samuel, Look not on his countenance... for the LORD seeth not as man seeth; for man looketh on the outward appearance, but the LORD looketh on the heart.”

1 SAMUEL 16:7

REFLECTION TWO · YOUR TURN

What does my mask look like? What do people see that is not the whole truth?

What am I most afraid would happen if the mask came off?

ONE MOVE TODAY

Notice one moment today when you reach for the mask. You do not have to drop it yet.
Just notice it, and tell God you noticed.

The Truth

Here is the truth I found in a place built to prove the opposite: you are not what you did, and you are not what was done to you. I murdered. I was lost. I thought I was beyond repair. And God brought beauty out of ashes anyway.

The cracks are real. The wounds are real. But they are not your name. If grace could find me in a level 4 prison yard and rebuild me from the inside out, it can find you exactly where you are sitting right now.

“Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new.”

2 CORINTHIANS 5:17

REFLECTION THREE · YOUR TURN

What have I been calling myself that God does not call me?

If I actually believed I could be made new, what would I do differently this week?

ONE MOVE TODAY

Write this where you will see it tomorrow: The cracks are where the light gets in. Then read the free first chapter of my book. It is the whole story, and it is yours free at unshackledtruthmedia.com/free-chapter.

This was the beginning, not the end

If something moved in you over these three reflections, do not let it go quiet. Healing is built out of small honest moves made daily, and you do not have to make them alone.

Here is the road I would walk with you, in order:

Keep going

- **Read Chapter One free.** The start of my story, straight to your inbox: unshackledtruthmedia.com/free-chapter
- **The Cracks Beneath the Surface.** The full book. Where the cracks came from, and the God who met me inside them.
- **The 7-Day Reflection Journal.** Seven days like the three you just did, one theme at a time: cracks, masks, pain, grace, surrender, rebuilding, next steps.

At sixteen I was sentenced to life. Everyone agreed I was too far gone, and for twenty-three years I believed them.

These three reflections are where my healing started: the crack, the mask, and the truth. They are free, because the men and women who need them most usually cannot pay for them.

“And he said unto me, My grace is sufficient for thee: for my strength is made perfect in weakness.”

2 CORINTHIANS 12:9

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